

## Chapter 2

### The Antichrist

Let us unlock another big piece of the puzzle concerning the mark of the beast: the beast himself. Theologians often compare the Antichrist to influential world leaders or corrupt businessmen to speculate on his future identity. But to gain insight into his schemes regarding the mark and his claim to be God, let us compare the Antichrist with the true Christ to gain further insights into his stratagems.

The Antichrist is more than just a political figure or a self-coronated false god; so much evidence is scattered and buried throughout the scriptures concerning his person, conduct, and intentions. Let us begin piecing them together. We are warned in Paul’s epistle to the Thessalonians that the Antichrist is introduced as “the man of lawlessness” and “the son of perdition” (2 Thes. 2:3-4). A man arriving before the return of Christ, and one who will claim himself to be the returning Christ and as god above every object of worship, taking a seat in the temple of God and setting up his images of worship (2 Thes. 2:4; Dan. 9:27; Rev. 14:9), proclaiming himself to be God. The Antichrist is first prophesied in the book of Daniel, among one of his many visions, and is further elaborated by John in the book of Revelation. And in the gospel of Matthew, Jesus spoke concerning this man of lawlessness in reference to Daniel’s prophecy (Matt. 24:15; Dan. 9:27, 12:11).

|                                                 | <b>The Christ</b>                                                                                                                                       | <b>The Antichrist</b>                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Claim to be the Messiah and God                 | The Lord Jesus is the Christ, the Son of the living God, and one with the Father (Matt. 16:16; John 10:30)                                              | Claims and exalts himself to be God (Dan. 11:36; 2 Thes. 2:4)                                                                                                              |
| Offered a deal to rule the world from the devil | The third temptation of Christ made by the devil in the wilderness (Matt. 4:8-9)                                                                        | Satan, who is the ruler of this world, giving his power, throne, authority to the Antichrist (John 14:30; Rev. 13:4)                                                       |
| Making of a covenant with God’s people          | Christ shedding His blood for the establishing of the new covenant with His people (Luke 22:20; 1 Cor. 11:25)                                           | The Antichrist will confirm a covenant with the children of Israel for seven years (cf. Dan. 7:25; Dan. 9:27)                                                              |
| Powerful beings in the end times                | Will slay the Antichrist by the breath of His mouth (2 Thes. 2:8; Rev. 19:15)                                                                           | Has global authority and dominance for a period (Rev. 13; Dan. 7:20-21)                                                                                                    |
| Death and resurrection                          | Humble, quiet, secret, doubted by His closest disciples (Matt. 28; John 20:25; cf. Luke 24)                                                             | Displayed, open, for the whole world to see, to marvel, and to believe (Rev. 13:3-4)                                                                                       |
| Seven-fold intensified                          | One Spirit prior to the last week, seven-fold Spirits during the last week, the Lamb with seven eyes and seven horns and diadems (Rev. 4:5, 5:6, 19:12) | The beast had originally one head with ten horns in Daniel’s vision (Dan. 7:20), and will have seven heads and ten diadems in the last week to parody the Lamb (Rev. 13:1) |

|                            |                                                                           |                                                                                         |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A marking for their people | The seal of God on the forehead of His people (Ezek. 9:6; Rev. 9:4, 22:4) | The mark of the beast on the right hand or forehead of his followers (Rev. 13:17; 20:4) |
| A trinity                  | The Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit                                  | Satan, the Antichrist, and the False Prophet (Rev 13:1, 4, 11)                          |

Both Christ and the Antichrist appeared in the ancient prophetic vision as powerful beings. They were both offered a deal with the devil himself to rule the world. They both made a covenant with God's people. They both claimed to be the Messiah and equal to God. They both will give their followers a form of marking to claim people as their own possession. And they both will play main character roles in the end times. There's even evidence contained in the lines of the Bible to suggest that the Antichrist will die and miraculously rise again, as an imitation of the true Christ's resurrection.

Therefore, we see that a key and recurring stratagem of God's adversary is, to be appropriately put, the shameless and blatant imitation of our true Christ and His works and accomplishments, by which he aims to deceive many, even the believers, into following him. As the Lord warned us beforehand that a time is coming when false prophets will arise and will show great signs and wonders so as to lead people astray, if possible, even the chosen. Many will be stumbled and fall away, even to betray and deliver up one another (Matt. 24:10-12, 23-24).

## The Visions of the Beast

Over 500 years before the birth of Christ, a man named Daniel saw a vision that greatly distressed him. The vision of the four beasts that arose from the sea, corresponding to the four successive empires (Babylonian, Medo-Persian, Grecian, and Roman) that possessed dominion over the holy land since the captivity of the children of Israel and until the time of Christ's first coming. The last of the four beasts, Daniel described as different from all three before it. Its presence was terrifying, being dreadful, frightful, and exceedingly strong, with large iron teeth and ten horns. The beast devoured, crushed, and trampled (Dan. 7:7).

Presenting each beast as a metaphor of a great human empire. To the fourth beast, which is the last and greatest human empire in Daniel's vision, it was given for it to devour the whole earth (Dan. 7:23), meaning the last human government will exercise power over the whole earth. Revelation 13:7 confirms this, detailing that this beast is given authority over every people, nation, and tongue. To clarify any confusion about whether the same beast seen by Daniel (Dan. 7:7) and by John (Rev. 13:1) is a collective human government (or empire) or an individual, it can be explained that both interpretations are correct and reinforce each other. The beast, who is the Antichrist, is an authoritarian individual, and his government and authority are the enlargement of this individual, hence still the same beast. We see that the small horn (representing the Antichrist)

that came up from the beast (representing his terrifying human government) is inseparably one with the beast, hence both the Antichrist and his government can be referred to as the beast.

And it is a great human government that the Antichrist will possess (Dan. 7:23-24). Among the beast's ten horns, a smaller one arose, uprooting three others. It has eyes of man, signifying the human appearance of the Antichrist (Dan. 7:8). With horns signifying might and power, the small horn arose to be greater than all other horns of the beast (Dan. 7:20) signifies that the Antichrist rise to a position of authority greater and more powerful than all the rulers of the last human government on earth. When Daniel asked for the interpretation from the angel that showed him the vision, the angel referred to the smaller horn that rose up as "he" and "his" (Dan. 7:25). Explaining that he, the small horn, speaks things against the God, the Most High, and wages war with the saints and wears out the saints and will prevail against them (Dan. 7:21; Rev. 13:7).

The angel also points out to Daniel that he, the small horn, intends on changing the times and the law of the children of Israel (Dan. 7:25), aligning with his will of causing the sacrifice and the oblation written within the law to cease, setting up his image in the temple as an idol to defile the holy temple (Matt. 24:15; Rev. 13:14-15; 2 Thes. 2:4). And God's people will be given into his hands for a time (1) and times (2) and half a time (0.5), totalling to three and a half years. Incredibly, this corresponds to the length of time of 1290 days that the daily sacrifice is removed and the abomination that desolates is set up (Dan. 12:11) and the trampling of the earthly Jerusalem for 42 months (Rev. 11:2).

Undoubtably from Daniel's vision, the prophesy concerning the Antichrist from the vision of the four beasts reveals that the fourth beast, will exercise power and authority over the whole earth (Dan. 7:23; Rev. 13:7). And out of this empire (beast), the Antichrist (small horn) will arise from (Dan. 7:7), being greater than all other horns of the beast (Dan. 7:20). Nonetheless, as grim and terrifying as Daniel's vision in Daniel chapter seven may seem, which is alarming to us as equally as it was to Daniel, there is the Son of Man, the true Christ, also appearing in this same chapter. Daniel saw that Christ as the Son of Man was coming, and they brought Him before God the Father (Dan. 7:13). And Daniel saw that Christ will come, not alone, but together with His saints in His second coming to take away his dominion (Dan. 7:26; cf. Joel 3:11; Jude 14) be given to His people and His saints (Dan. 7:27; Rev. 22:5).

Knowing that the words of the prophesy are faithful and true, it is reasonable to be alarmed in understanding the interpretations concerning the rise and authority of the Antichrist, as equally as Daniel himself was (Dan. 7:15). We do not yet know whether the mark of the Antichrist was a method that enabled him to seize control, or a method to tighten his authoritarian grasp over the world. Though both scenarios are plausible, one thing is certain: the mark of the beast carries an element of commerce. Revelation 13:17 reveals that the money of the people without the mark

could not be used in buying or selling; a critical detail of the mark, which we will explore in greater depth throughout this chapter.

The prophecies and truth unlocked by Daniel, and later the apostle John in Revelation are certain, the Antichrist will be given authority over the whole earth (Dan. 7:23; Rev. 13:2) and over every nation and people (Rev. 13:7). And he, alongside the False Prophet, will exercise their authority over the world and will be ruthless in forcing everyone in the world, whether small or great, rich or poor, free or slaves, to be given the mark of the beast (Rev. 13:16). The choice to all of humanity in the last three and a half years (Dan. 7:25) is clear, receive the mark of the beast and worship him, or lose the ability to use money.

### The Number of the Beast

John further reveals to us in chapter 13 that the mark of the beast is the number of the Antichrist, or a representation or symbol of his name, such as a number (Rev. 13:17, 15:2), to mark people out for himself. And John has provided us with the number of the beast’s name, “666”, and said let him who has understanding calculate this number (Rev. 13:18), hence we see that the number “666” is not literally or directly the mark or the name of the Antichrist, but requires understanding and calculation from this number to arrive at his name.

With the help of gematria, the system of assigning numerical values to letters in ancient languages like Hebrew or Greek, writers were able to embed hidden words or phrases in numbers. John cleverly revealed that the name hidden in the number “666” when decoded with Hebrew letters, is the name Caesar Nero, commonly spelled as Caesar Neron (Νέρων Καῖσαρ) in Greek. The extra “n” is not an oddity or modification, but standard grammar of Koine Greek spoken at the time of John’s writing, with the final “-ων” ending being a regular Greek nominative form for masculine names.

The Greek name of Caesar Nero (Νέρων Καῖσαρ) transliterated into Hebrew (נרון קסר):

| Greek letters | Hebrew letters | Letter name | Number |
|---------------|----------------|-------------|--------|
| Νέ            | נ              | (nun)       | 50     |
| ρ             | ר              | (resh)      | 200    |
| ω             | ו              | (waw)       | 6      |
| ν             | ן              | (nun final) | 50     |
|               |                |             |        |
| Καῖ           | ק              | (kuf)       | 100    |
| σα            | ס              | (samekh)    | 60     |
| ρ             | ר              | (resh)      | 200    |
|               |                |             | = 666  |

Interesting to note, the Greek word “beast” (θηρίον) written in the book of Revelation transliterated into Hebrew (תריון) also amounts to the number “666”:

| Hebrew letters | Name   | Number |
|----------------|--------|--------|
| ת              | (tav)  | 400    |
| ר              | (resh) | 200    |
| י              | (yod)  | 10     |
| ו              | (waw)  | 6      |
| נ              | (nun)  | 50     |
|                |        | = 666  |

The number of the beast is the number of a man (Rev. 13:18), the man in question is no other than Caesar Nero. But what is even more fascinating is the confirmation of the name of the Antichrist found in a 3rd century manuscript of the book of Revelation, Papyrus 115, in which the most discussed section is its reading of Revelation 13:18. In many later manuscripts, this verse reads the number of the beast being “666” written in Greek using chi-xi-stigma “ΧΞϚ”. However, Papyrus 115 shows the number “616” using chi-iota-stigma “ΧΙϚ” in ancient Greek gematria.

Such a contradiction ostensibly throws a wrench into the interpretation of the name of the beast in Revelation 13:18, with two different numbers presented by separate manuscripts. However, the number “616” in Papyrus 115 in fact provides a confirmation of the name of the beast alongside “666”, and eliminates other potential candidates whose names also coincidentally sum to “666” when transliterated into Hebrew. Crucially, the alternative reading of “616” found in the early manuscript Papyrus 115 matches the Hebrew transliteration of the Latin form of his name (NERO CAESAR) into Hebrew (נרו קסר), which drops the “ן” nun-final with the value of 50, thus summing up to “616”.

| Hebrew letters | Name     | Number |
|----------------|----------|--------|
| נ              | (nun)    | 50     |
| ר              | (resh)   | 200    |
| ו              | (waw)    | 6      |
|                |          |        |
| ק              | (kuf)    | 100    |
| ס              | (samekh) | 60     |
| ר              | (resh)   | 200    |
|                |          | = 616  |

| Greek        | English Transliteration | Hebrew Transliteration | Hebrew Gematria Sum |
|--------------|-------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| Νέρων Καῖσαρ | Caesar Neron            | נרון קסר               | 666                 |

| Latin       |             |         |     |
|-------------|-------------|---------|-----|
| NERO CAESAR | Caesar Nero | נרו קסר | 616 |

With the number two in the Bible representing witness or confirmation (cf. Deut. 19:15; Matt. 18:16). What turns out to be a discrepancy in the two numbers of Revelation 13:18 found in distinct manuscripts serves to confirm the name of the Antichrist, that is, the number of his name. Both the number “666” in John’s original writing of the book of Revelation and “616” in the manuscript Papyrus 115 refer to the name of Caesar Nero, showing how early authors utilised flexible numerical codes to point toward the emperor across different cultural and linguistic contexts within the Roman Empire.

Numbers throughout the Bible carry symbolisms and significance, with the examples of the number one representing unity (Gen. 2:24), two being witness (Deut. 19:15), and seven representing completion (Gen. 2:2). From Genesis to Revelation, the number six in the Bible represents humanity and imperfection: Man was created on the sixth day. Because six falls one short of the completion represented by number seven, it represents man’s state of being incomplete without God. It is equally intriguing to touch upon the number of the solution to the mark to be discussed at the end of this chapter: Bitcoin. When asked among Bitcoiners what number is attributed to Bitcoin, the answer in consensus would be “21”. It is the author’s own interpretation that the number of Bitcoin, “21”, symbolically presents itself as “one-up” from the number of the mark, “666”, with “21” being a factor between 3 and 7 in multiplication, or the sum of three 7s in addition, implying the number “777” from “21”. Though this remains a compelling observation, it remains undetermined whether this interpretation and comparison between the two numbers is more than a coincidence.

As the Bible is full of types and figures, whether the coming Antichrist is exactly Nero remains yet unknown, and the author believes further hypothetical exploration into the realm of speculation will prove unprofitable. But as the name denotes the person, the Antichrist will most likely be a person who is, or most similar to, the person of Caesar Nero in his conduct and character. Having been named by John in the book of Revelation and confirmed by other early Christian writers as the coming Antichrist, to gain further understanding into the beast and his mark, let us see what has been done by this despotic emperor in history in relation to the mark of the beast while he was once alive on the earth.

## Neronian Monetary and Economic Control

The historical investigation into the reign of Caesar Nero (AD 54-68) reveals a consequential period in Roman governance and church history, one of biblical significance, characterised by the unprecedented centralisation of economic authority and weaponisation of monetary, economic,

and financial systems to enforce political and religious loyalty to the emperor. Central to this period were the Neronian monetary reforms alongside the evolution of the imperial charagma (a transliterated English word from Greek, meaning mark or seal), which functioned not merely as a decorative element of the state bureaucracy, but as a vital mechanism for the regulation of commerce and the validation of state loyalty.

### The Mark in the 1st Century

To understand the historical reality behind the mark of the beast in the times of the early church, at the time of the apostle John, one must first examine the technical and social applications of the charagma in the mid-first century. The charagma was a commonplace administrative tool long before the writing of the book of Revelation. In the legal and commercial environment of the Roman Empire, the charagma primarily denoted an official stamp, engraving, or seal used to authenticate government documents. Often bearing the image of the emperor and the year of his reign, they were essential for the legal recognition of bills of sale, rental agreements, and promissory notes (1).

The charagma functioned as a "legal signature" that carried the full authority of the imperial owner, providing the necessary security for transactions in a vast, disparate empire. Beyond the bureaucratic realm, the term extended to the branding of livestock and, more significantly, the branding of human property. Disobedient slaves were often "marked" with the charagma of their owners (cf. Rev. 13:16), a practice that designated permanent ownership and served as a visible warning to the rest of society (2). This socio-economic context suggests that the mark required for buying and selling, or for any other permissioned activity, was likely perceived by the first-century audience as an outward sign of ownership and submission to the owner of the mark.

### Nero’s Authoritative Monetary Manipulation

The reign of Nero is distinguished by a radical departure from the established monetary system of the Roman Empire. Following the catastrophic Great Fire of Rome in AD. 64, the emperor faced a financial crisis precipitated by the immense costs of reconstruction and the development of his opulent Domus Aurea (Golden House). To address this deficit, Nero initiated an empire-wide debasement of the Roman currency, an act marking the beginning of state-managed inflation in the Roman Empire and the direct manipulation of the Roman monetary system.

| Emperor / Period | Denarius Weight (Approx) | Silver Purity Percentage | Percentage Change |
|------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------|
|                  |                          |                          |                   |

|                             |            |          |                           |
|-----------------------------|------------|----------|---------------------------|
| Augustus (Early Principate) | 3.90 grams | 98% Fine | Base Standard             |
| Nero (Pre-64 AD. Reform)    | 3.75 grams | 98% Fine | Base Standard             |
| Nero (Post-64 AD. Reform)   | 3.41 grams | 80% Fine | ~25% Reduction in Content |

By being the first Roman Emperor to exercise authoritative control over the empire's monetary system, Nero's reforms were not merely fiscal; they were an exercise of absolute imperial sovereignty over the economic activities of all peoples and tongues within the empire's borders. By reducing the silver content of the Denarius while maintaining its face value, the state effectively forced the populace to accept "fiat" value backed solely by the emperor's authority.

To ensure the success of this reform, Nero's administration took measures to remove older, finer Republican and early imperial coins from circulation, largely through recalls from provincial mints like Alexandria and Syria (3). This policy of "recycling" old silver was a massive commitment by the empire to control the medium of exchange within its borders. For the citizenry, the ability to engage in trade was now explicitly tied to the acceptance of the emperor's debased coinage, a currency that bore Nero's image (cf. Mark 12:16) and his claims to divinity, such as the sun god Apollo (4).

## **Economic Activities within the Empire**

The prohibition of trade without the imperial mark was facilitated through the social and religious structures that governed the Roman marketplace, particularly in the provinces of Asia Minor (cf. Rev. 1:4) and Judea. The macellum (public food market) and the collegia (trade guilds) served as the primary environments where an individual's loyalty to the state was tested and enforced through economic activities.

Guild membership often required participation in communal feasts and sacrifices dedicated to the guild's patron idol deity and the reigning emperor. For Christians and pious Jews, these rituals were inherently idolatrous. Refusal to participate led to exclusion from the guild, which in turn resulted in the loss of commercial privileges, the inability to secure contracts and leases for a stall, and a general "social death" that made it impossible to function effectively in the local economy. It is no wonder that the apostle Paul, being a tentmaker by trade to sustain himself financially (1 Cor. 4:12) did not join himself to any guilds of his trade, but to fellow Christians who

were of the same trade (Acts 18:1-3). This exclusion was one of many foreshadowings of trade prohibition mentioned in Revelation 13:17, where those without the mark and do not participate in the compliance and worship of the beast would face total economic exclusion.

When the apostle Paul was walking through the streets of Athens, his spirit was provoked within him by the sight of many idols in public, one notable place of idol worship noted in Paul's gospel ministry in Athens being the marketplace (Acts 17:16-17). The macellum (public food market) was the central hub for the sale of meat, fish, and luxury consumables, and it was deeply intertwined with the religious life of Roman cities (cf. Acts 16:19, 17:17, 28:15). Records also indicate that these markets often housed shrines to idols such as Mercury, Neptune, and the divinised emperor (cf. Acts 17:22-23) as witnessed by the apostle. Therefore, significant portion of the meat sold in the macellum was "sacrificial meat", derived from animals slaughtered in public religious ceremonies (Acts 15:29), with the consumption of such meat quickly becoming a source of contention in early churches, most notably for the church in Corinth (1 Cor. 8, 10:25-31).

For the inhabitants of cities across the empire, the marketplace was by no means a neutral commercial space. The ability to buy food and trade within these markets was frequently contingent on acknowledging the imperial system that provided the market facilities. Under Nero, the monumental market of Macellum Magnum in Rome served as a prototype for this integration of state architecture, religious devotion, and commercial regulation. For Jews and early Christians, the interference and mixture of the state and idol worship with marketplaces meant participation in essential economic activities, such as buying food, became impossible without making a compromise to their faith.

## **The Continuity of the Beast: From Nero to Decius**

The authoritative control of currency and the leverage of trade access to enforce compliance to idol religion and the emperor were not isolated to Nero's reign. However, they established a precedent that would culminate in the third century. While the Neronian charagma was often sectoral or localised through guilds of tradesmen, it provided the administrative basis for the empire-wide libellus (meaning 'certificate') system under Emperor Decius (AD 249 - 251).

The Decian edict required every citizen to perform a sacrifice to the Roman gods and the emperor's well-being in the presence of a magistrate. Those who complied received a libellus, or certificate of sacrifice. Without this "mark" of approval, individuals were strictly prohibited from pursuing trades and conducting business in the public marketplace. Historians and theologians have noted that this prohibition conceivably goes back to Nero, as it represents the same "religion of loyalty" used as a prerequisite for economic participation (1).

The Neronian Principate thus served as the ground zero for the beastly economic model that would shape the rest of the empire's history, as seen in Revelation chapter 13. By debasing the

currency, standardising the imperial charagma on commercial documents, and utilising trade guilds and marketplace as religious and political filters to economic activities, the Roman state under Nero was a system where the state could effectively embed a form of mark as a “right to participate” in economic activities. The inability to buy or to sell (economic participation in guilds and markets) without a mark (the charagma or libellus) was the ultimate manifestation of this authoritative control, adulterating the marketplace from its function of providing economic welfare into a site of idol worship and political submission.

## **The Economic Implications of the Mark**

Though history does not repeat, it rhymes all too familiarly. The historical evidence indicates that the Neronian era witnessed the first cohesive attempt by the Roman state to centralise economic life around the person of the emperor. This was represented through three primary mechanisms of authoritative control: the manipulation of the currency standard, the bureaucratic requirement of the imperial charagma for commercial validation, and the religious gatekeeping of public markets and guilds. Nero’s monetary reforms shifted the basis of economic value from the intrinsic worth of the silver Denarius from its metal content to the sovereign authority dictated by the emperor; a prelude to fiat currencies, a practice of state control and issuance of fiat money, where the value of currency is wholly determined and dictated by the state. Such transition into the Neronian economy required the populace to place their faith in the “mark” of the emperor rather than the material reality and worth of the coin.

The prohibition of buying and selling written in Revelation 13:17 is a remarkably accurate description of the socio-economic pressures faced by those who refused to participate in the imperial cult of the emperor and the religious worship of idols. An issue highly significant and relevant to the early church during the times of the writings of the epistles (1 Cor. 8; 1 Thes. 1:9; 1 John 5:21) and the book of Revelation. Whether through the dilemma of social and economic exclusion enforced politically or culturally, devices or practices symbolic of a “mark” in the times of the Roman Empire represented the individual’s choice to submit to a system that demanded allegiance in exchange for economic survival. With the numerical identification of Nero through gematria serving as the historical anchor for this analysis, confirming that the early church recognised this system of totalising political, social, and economic control as the defining characteristic of Caesar Nero, the beast.

The Neronian precedent established the framework for later, more formalised persecutions, such as those under Decius and Diocletian, where the libellus functioned as the literal fulfilment of the trade-prohibiting seal. For the readers of the early church, the mark of the beast was no futuristic enigma, but a documented administrative strategy of the Roman Emperor initiated under Nero and perpetuated by his successors that the early church lived through, whereby the Roman state leveraged its control over the marketplace to enforce the worship of Roman deities, including the

emperor himself. The history of the early church and the records of economic persecutions faced by early Christians under Nero's reign and his successors of the past provides us a picture to the socio-economic consequences of the coming mark of the beast that will be enforced upon the whole world. A picture and warning that becomes ever clearer with the trend of ever-increasing centralisation and digitalisation of the world's commercial, monetary, and banking systems.

## **The True Christ**

Before we conclude this chapter, I would like to offer a word of advice. Researching about the Antichrist (and the False Prophet) will most likely lead you down a rabbit hole with no end. But I am certain that after finishing this chapter, you probably need to spend no more time in researching about the Antichrist, and you might naturally uncover more about his person, character, and plans as you journey through the Bible. So, don't spend all your time and energy researching the Antichrist, or the time he will come, when the true Christ is just exceedingly better.

It is true that we should not be ignorant of his schemes, but the best preparation you do is believe and receive the true Christ, Jesus, the Son of God, through spending quality with Him in His word and prayer, and allowing Him to give you His life and make His home in your heart. Know that whoever receives the true Christ, shall by no means be snatched after from His caring hands (John 10:28). Lastly, if you are fearful of the Antichrist's rule, the Lord has a word of encouragement, turn to Him, and He will come to you, His love is perfect, and it will drive away all fear. And if God is for us, who can be against us?